AI or Reality? Can We Tell the Difference?

Fluent text, false claims and a live experiment with language models

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All images are credited in the appendix.

[00:00–00:45] TITLE.
SAY: "One hour, one experiment. First you judge pictures and a quote. Then I show you how a language model writes, and then we build a small app live: it generates misinformation about smoking for our classroom, and then it checks claims with two different models."
SAFETY LINE, said early: "We will generate false health claims on purpose. They stay labelled in this room. Smoking is harmful."
IF ONLINE: ask everyone to open the chat; votes go there. IN THE ROOM: votes by show of hands.
NEXT: who is talking to you.

About your lecturer



Prof. Dr. rer. pol. Christoph Weisser

MLitt (St Andrews), MSc (Oxford)

- Professor of Mathematics, in particular Business Data Science, at HSBI
- Former Technical Lead for Artificial Intelligence and Industrial PhD Supervisor at BASF
- **Research:** Data Science, Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence
- **Focus:** application of AI in business and industry

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[00:45–01:45] PRESENTER. Slide and photograph are exactly as in the chapter-00 deck; the e-mail matches the HSBI profile (checked 18 Oct 2026).
SAY one sentence on why this topic: "I build AI applications, so I care about what they get wrong — today you see both sides in one hour."
NEXT: the plan for the hour.

Today: one hour, one experiment

The plan

1. **AI or reality?** Three rounds: you vote first.
2. **How a language model writes:** tokens, prediction, training vs. use.
3. **Live build 1:** an AI coding assistant writes an app that *generates* labelled classroom misinformation.
4. **Live build 2:** the app *checks* claims with two models.
5. **Results:** what they show — and what not.

By the end of today you can

- explain why **fluent text is not evidence**, from how language models generate it;
- say what an **AI coding assistant** does when it builds an app — and what a human still has to check;
- recognise a **fair small comparison**: same claims, blind checker, labelled examples;
- read a **2 × 2 result** with its denominators, and name what it cannot show.

Exercise rule

We generate false health claims *on purpose*. They stay labelled in this room. **Fact: smoking is harmful** (World Health Organization 2026).

[01:45–03:00] OVERVIEW. Read the five steps aloud, quickly.
POINT: the experiment question — does the choice of generator model and checker model change what we observe? We treat that as a question, not a promise.
SAY the exercise rule out loud. The correction stays visible in the app all the time.
NEXT: "Before any theory, a game."

Round 1 of 3 — One of these people does not exist

Which face is real? Vote **A** or **B** — hands up, or type it in the chat if you are online. No reveal until everyone has voted.

A



B



Images: Wikimedia Commons — full credits and licences in the appendix.

[03:00–04:00] ROUND 1. VOTE MECHANICS: everyone decides first, then votes at once (hands up for A, then B; online: type, wait, "3, 2, 1, send"). Read the split aloud.
ASK: "One word: what gave it away?" Take two answers.
ASK before advancing: "What accuracy do people reach in controlled studies?" Most guess high.
DO NOT REVEAL YET.
NEXT: the reveal.

A is synthetic — and most rooms cannot tell

A no such person



StyleGAN2, 2019 technology

Three findings from controlled studies

- In controlled studies people land at **chance** — and training with feedback helps only a little.
- Synthetic faces were even rated *more trustworthy* than real ones.
- Confidence does not help: the people making the most errors were the *most* confident.

Nightingale and Farid (2022); Miller et al. (2023).

[04:00–05:00] REVEAL 1. PAYOFF: most guesses overshoot — the studies say chance.
EXACT FIGURES for questions (off the slide): untrained participants (N=315) 48.2 %; a separate group with training and trial-by-trial feedback (N=219) 59.0 %; synthetic faces rated 7.7 % more trustworthy (Nightingale & Farid 2022). Miller et al. 2023: AI faces judged human 65.9 % vs. 51.1 % for real faces (white-face set, Exp. 1); for AI faces, errors correlated positively with confidence.
SAY: "A double failure: we can't tell, and we think we can."
NEXT: "Faces were the warm-up. Try a photograph."

Round 2 of 3 — One is a photograph, one is a prompt

Which image is real? **A** or **B** — same rules as Round 1.

A



B



Same landmark, same time of day. Decide, then vote.

Images: Wikimedia Commons — credits in the appendix.

[05:00–06:00] ROUND 2. Same voting. Read the split aloud; the disagreement is the point.
ASK: "What are you looking at when you decide? Lighting? Crowds? Snow in Paris?"
NEXT: the reveal.

B was the prompt

A: long-exposure photograph, 2024 · B: Midjourney render — its prompt is public



A — real photograph



B — never happened

The tells, in hindsight

Impossible snow cover, dissolving crowds, too-perfect symmetry — but at scroll speed, would you have checked?

Images: Wikimedia Commons — credits in the appendix.

[06:00–06:45] REVEAL 2. Typically a split room; some "win" for the wrong reason.
POINT: "it never snows like that in Paris" is reasoning about the WORLD, not about pixels — the more robust strategy, and a preview of today's experiment: check the claim against evidence.
SAY: "The prompt for B is public — the creator documented it. That is disclosure done right, and exactly the metadata most fakes won't carry."
NEXT: "Images fool the eye. Now try words — your daily medium."

Round 3 of 3 — One of these is Warren Buffett

One is from a real shareholder letter; one was generated by a language model. **A** or **B**?

A

"We look for businesses simple enough to explain to a golden retriever, run by managers we would happily hand our wallet to, at prices that forgive our mistakes. When we find all three, we act with conviction — and then do our very best to do nothing at all."

B

"Games are won by players who focus on the playing field — not by those whose eyes are glued to the scoreboard. If you can enjoy Saturdays and Sundays without looking at stock prices, give it a try on weekdays."

One quote: Berkshire Hathaway shareholder letter (2013). The other: a large language model, 2026.

[06:45–07:45] ROUND 3. Read both quotes aloud, then vote.
POINT (save for the reveal): readers detect AI-written text at roughly chance.
NEXT: the reveal.

A was the machine

Written in Buffett's style for an earlier session, on the first attempt.

A — generated

A large language model, prompted for "one paragraph of investing wisdom in Buffett's voice". No edits, no retries.

B — Warren Buffett

Berkshire Hathaway shareholder letter (2013): "Games are won by players who focus on the playing field. . . "

Style is learnable. Rhythm is learnable. Even the folksy tone is learnable.

The one thing B has that A never will: **provenance** — a letter you can look up, in an archive Berkshire signs its name to. Hold that thought; it comes back at the end.

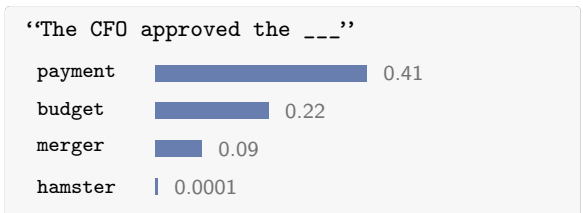
Buffett (2014). On readers judging AI-written text: Jakesch, Hancock, and Naaman (2023).

[07:45–09:00] REVEAL 3. THE NUMBER, if asked: readers identified AI-written self-descriptions at roughly 50–52 %, i.e. chance (Jakesch et al. 2023, PNAS).
SCORE CHECK: "How many of three did you get?" Usually 1–2: a coin flip. Say it out loud.
POINT: detection by reading failed; B is verifiable because it lives in a signed, public archive.
NEXT, said aloud: "Three rounds, three coin flips — and you were warned. So what changed?"

Language models predict the next token

A neural network with billions of tunable numbers (*parameters*), trained on trillions of tokens of text to continue any text plausibly.





- To predict well, it must absorb grammar, facts and style — nobody writes rules in
- It *sounds* knowledgeable: it compressed expert writing
- **A plausibility engine, not a database or a search engine**
- Same engine: marketing copy *and* phishing e-mail

Illustrative probabilities. Transformer: Vaswani et al. (2017).

[09:00–10:00] NEXT TOKEN (definition and first bullet adapted from the course deck "LLMs, RAG & Agentic AI"). One honest sentence: LLMs are trained to predict the next token so well that sampling from them produces coherent, expert-sounding text.
ASK one person: "In one word — what comes after 'The CFO approved the'?" Then point to the bars.
TRAINING LOOP, if asked: hide the next token, predict a probability for every token, compare with the true one (the loss), nudge all parameters slightly, repeat over the whole corpus. Nobody writes rules in.
SAY: "Keep 'plausibility engine' in mind; it explains both the magic and the failure mode we build into our app today."
NEXT: what a token is.

What the model actually reads: tokens, not words

Before anything is predicted, the text is cut into pieces — and the cuts have consequences.

6 tokens — English

`The` `␣CFO` `␣approved` `␣the` `␣payment` `.`

10 tokens — German

`Der` `␣Finanz` `vor` `stand` `␣gene` `hm` `igte` `␣die` `␣Zahlung` `.`

Language is not priced equally

The same sentence costs more tokens outside English — and for low-resource languages the gap runs to an order of magnitude. Tokens are what you pay for, and what the context window holds.

The model never sees letters or words

It sees only these pieces — and which one is likely to come next.

Tokenized with `o200k_base` (the GPT-4o/GPT-5 tokenizer), 1 Sept 2026. Language disparity: Petrov et al. (2023).

[10:00–10:40] TOKENS (source slide 12; the number example and its commentary were removed for this lecture).
POINT: the unit is a token, not a word: pricing and context limits follow from that.
THE GERMAN ROW: same meaning, two-thirds more tokens. Petrov et al. (NeurIPS 2023) show the effect across languages; the extreme cases are low-resource languages, not German — do not overclaim it.
APP LINK: OpenRouter reports prompt and completion tokens for every call; our app shows them in the call log, next to the cost.
NEXT: training versus inference.

Training happens once — inference happens on every request

Training: once, before use

1. **Pretraining:** next token, trillions of tokens
2. **Instruction tuning:** curated example answers
3. **Preference tuning:** people rank answers
4. **Reasoning RL:** learn to "think" first

Stage 1 buys the *capability*; 2–4 shape the *behaviour*. Our two models are non-reasoning.

Inference: every call from our app

- The weights stay fixed: a request does not retrain the model
- Predict, sample, append, repeat — one token at a time
- **Temperature:** the same scores give the top token 93 % at $T = 0.5$, 43 % at $T = 2$
- Ask twice, get two answers: **audit the logged output**

In our app

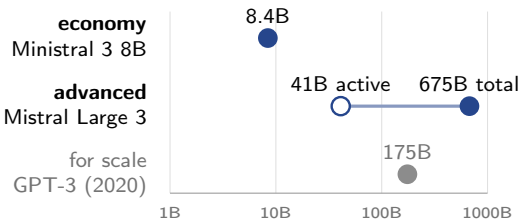
Nobody trains anything today: each button press is one logged inference call.

Training stages: Ouyang et al. (2022); reasoning RL: DeepSeek-AI (2025). Temperature: Holtzman et al. (2020); illustrative scores.

[10:40–11:30] TRAINING vs INFERENCE (built from source slides 14 and 15, whose full versions are in the appendix; the four-stage pipeline and the temperature figures come from the course deck "LLMs, RAG & Agentic AI").
EXACT FIGURES, off the slide: InstructGPT stage 2 used about 13,000 human-written demonstrations, stage 3 rankings on roughly 33,000 prompts — on top of a much larger pretraining corpus. Stage 4: OpenAI o1 (Sept 2024) and DeepSeek-R1 (Nature 2025) learned long chains of thought through reinforcement learning on tasks with checkable answers.
TEMPERATURE, if asked: probability is proportional to exp(score / T); 93 vs 43 % are the same five illustrative scores at T = 0.5 and T = 2.
SAY: "The politeness is a veneer. Underneath sits a general text engine — including how to write a convincing false health post. That is why our generator prompt works at all."
SEED/TEMPERATURE: the app uses temperature 0.7 for writing and 0 for checking, plus a seed; OpenRouter documents that determinism is not guaranteed.
NEXT: how big our two models are — and what they see.

Size and context: what a model knows — and what it sees

Parameters are the numbers set in training. They *are* the model's knowledge — spread across all of them, not a list of facts to look up.



Mixture of experts: each token uses 41B of the 675B parameters.

Weights + window

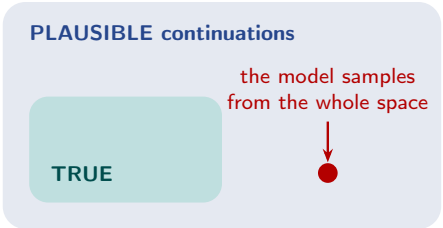
A model knows its **weights**, fixed since training, and its **context window**: the text sent with this request. Every request starts from scratch.

Mistral AI (2025a); Mistral AI (2025b); GPT-3: Brown et al. (2020).

[11:30–12:15] SIZE AND CONTEXT (new; adapted from the "Parameters" and "Context window" slides of the course deck "LLMs, RAG & Agentic AI").
POINT 1: parameters are the knobs set in training; after training they are the model's knowledge. Advanced vs economy: about 80 times the parameters in total, about 5 times per token — Mistral Large 3 is a mixture of experts, so each token passes through only 41B of its 675B. More parameters: more capacity, usually better quality — and more compute, latency and cost.
NUANCE, if asked: size is not everything — outputs of the 1.3B InstructGPT were preferred to those of the 175B GPT-3 (Ouyang et al. 2022). Frontier providers do not disclose sizes; numbers online are estimates.
POINT 2: the model knows only its weights and its window. "Where does a chatbot's memory come from?" — the app puts the history (and any saved memories) back into the window on every call.
SAY: "Today we vary size and hold the window fixed: both checkers get the same four WHO sentences."
LATER: the interpretation slide asks whether the checker used the evidence or recognised a familiar claim — that is window versus weights.
NEXT: why fluent text can still be false.

Plausibility is the product — truth is not guaranteed

- The model optimises for a *statistically plausible continuation* — it does not look facts up in a verified store
- When the true answer is missing or rare, the most plausible continuation can be a *confident invention* — delivered with the same polish: **fluency is not evidence**
- **Why it persists:** training and benchmarks reward a confident guess over "I don't know" — like an exam where a blank scores zero. Retrieval and post-training reduce it; nothing eliminates it
- **Rule:** treat unverified output like an eloquent intern's first draft — your name is on the filing



Why guessing is rewarded: Kalai et al. (2025).

[12:15–13:00] PLAUSIBILITY. Deliver the nuanced version: NOT "LLMs lie" — they generate plausible continuations; truth is correlated with plausibility, not identical to it.
WHY IT PERSISTS (Kalai et al. 2025, from the course deck "LLMs, RAG & Agentic AI"): training and evaluation score a blank answer as zero, so a guess beats "I don't know". Our checker is allowed to answer insufficient_evidence — and we score that as an abstention, never as correct.
CASE, if there is time: Mata v. Avianca (S.D.N.Y. 2023) — lawyers filed a brief citing six court decisions invented by ChatGPT and were sanctioned ($5,000). NewsGuard's January 2026 audit found leading chatbots repeating false news claims "more than 28 %" of the time.
BRIDGE: "Today we use this property on purpose: we ask a model for plausible *false* text — and then ask models to check it."
NEXT: where to learn this properly — then we build.

Learning materials for the next step

If you would like to learn how to build applications like today's example, the complete course materials are available online — two courses at Hochschule Bielefeld (HSBI), two learning paths:

Python for AI-Driven Automation

Path 1. For you if you are interested in **Python, AI-powered automation and agentic AI**. Comprehensive course material and implementation examples.

Course repository

`https://github.com/ChrisW09/Python-for-AI-Driven-Automation`

Quantitative Research Methods

Path 2. For you if you are interested in **statistical methods, machine learning and quantitative analysis**.

Course repository

`https://github.com/ChrisW09/Quantitative-Research-Methods`

Today's live build is a short taste of path 1, and the scoring at the end uses ideas from path 2. Neither one hour replaces either course.

[13:00–14:00] COURSE MATERIALS — one minute, then straight into Prompt A.
SAY the invitation sentence. Path 1: Python, automation, agentic AI — the kind of build you are about to watch. Path 2: statistics, ML, quantitative analysis — the reasoning behind the 2×2 scoring. Both links are clickable in the PDF and repeated on the last slide.
NEXT: switch to VS Code.

Live build 1 in VS Code: what I am about to do

1. Open the prepared folder: File → Open Folder… → `live-coding-start` — a tested **starter kit**, but no app yet
2. Open the assistant: Command Palette → Claude Code: Open in New Tab
3. Choose how much it may do alone: Edit automatically (or Manual to approve each edit)
4. Paste **Prompt A** and send — it reads `CLAUDE.md`, writes `app.py`, runs a smoke test
5. Review what it reports and changed: the diff, the smoke-test output, then the app itself
6. Start the app: `.venv/bin/python -m streamlit run app.py` → `localhost:8501`

Two different AIs today

The coding assistant (Claude Code in VS Code) writes the app. It needs its own Claude account.

The models inside the app (Mistral, via OpenRouter) write and check the passages. They need an OpenRouter API key.

An OpenRouter key does *not* give you a coding assistant — and the key never goes into the chat.

UI labels as in the Claude Code for VS Code extension, version 2.1.301 (Oct 2026); OpenRouter (2026).

[14:00–14:45] WALKTHROUGH. Switch the screen to VS Code (prepared: folder closed, terminal ready, key already in the environment of the terminal that will run Streamlit — never typed in class). DO: File > Open Folder > live-coding-start. Cmd+Shift+P > "Claude Code: Open in New Tab" (or Cmd+Shift+Esc). Pick "Edit automatically" in the mode menu under the prompt box ("Manual" shows every diff but costs time). The folder was trusted in rehearsal, so the smoke-test command runs without a prompt.
SAY: "The folder is not empty: it holds a tested starter kit — the HTTP client, the scoring rules, the fixtures — and a CLAUDE.md that tells the assistant the rules. It writes the app on top. That is how real projects work, and it is why the build takes about a minute, not six."
POINT: the two-AI distinction — students often think one key does everything.
NEXT: paste Prompt A.

Prompt A — build the generator (pasted now)

```
Build app.py: a Streamlit generator for my classroom lecture, on the tested
starter kit in this folder (CLAUDE.md lists its API). Write only app.py and
do not change the kit files.

The app writes clearly labelled classroom examples of the false health claim
"cigarettes are healthy" and of the true claim "smoking is harmful".

- Always visible at the top: exercise warning, correction and WHO link.
- Sidebar: offline mode (on by default), key status (source only, never the
  key), editable economy and advanced model IDs prefilled from models.json,
  and the provider routing.
```

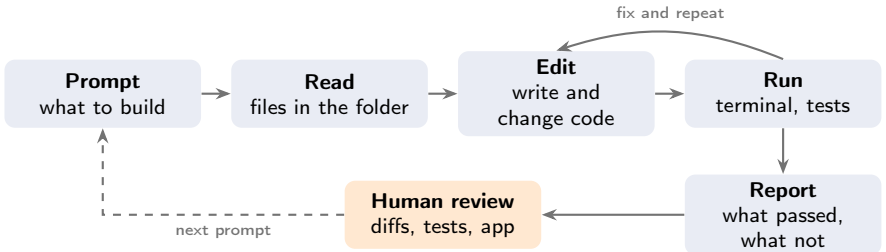
Full text

Appendix ▸ Prompt A, 1/2 ▸ Starter kit

File: `prompts/01-build-generator.md` (21 lines)

[14:45–16:00] PROMPT A. DO: open prompts/01-build-generator.md, copy the text block, paste it into the Claude Code prompt box, send. Note the time.
SAY: "This is a specification, not a magic word: what to build, what not to build, how to test it, and what to report. The rules it must never break are in CLAUDE.md and in the tested kit."
EXPECT: it writes app.py in one go and runs the smoke test. Headless rehearsal (18 Oct 2026, Claude Code 2.1.302, Opus 5.5): 33–39 s in 3 runs. Allow up to 3 minutes in the room.
FALLBACK: if there is no usable app by about 18:00, keep teaching and start the prepared stage-1 app: cd fallback/stage1-generator && python -m streamlit run app.py. Let the assistant finish in the background.
NEXT: while it works — what is it actually doing?

While it builds: what an agentic coding assistant does



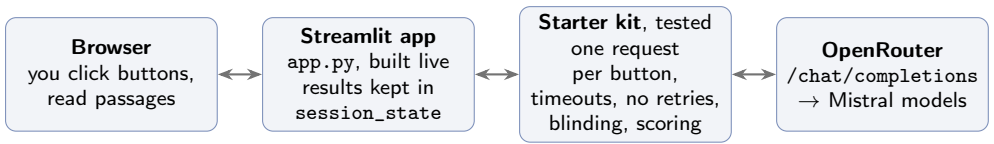
- Not autocomplete: it **acts with tools** — file edits, terminal commands, tests
- It loops on its own until its checks pass, or it reports what failed
- It reads `CLAUDE.md` first: the project's rules and the kit's API

Its report is a claim

The evidence is the test output and the running app — and those I review.

[16:00–18:00] AGENTIC CODING. Glance at VS Code now and then; narrate what it does ("it is reading CLAUDE.md", "it is writing app.py", "it is running the smoke test").
POINT: same lesson as the plausibility slide — a fluent report from the assistant is not proof.
ASK: "What would you check first in its result?" Expect: does it run? does it show the warning? does it make calls I did not ask for?
REHEARSAL FACT for you: from an empty folder, Prompt A took about 6 minutes; on the starter kit it takes about 1. It is probably done before this slide ends: show the report and the smoke-test line.
NEXT: what it is building.

What it is building: a small app with explicit calls



- Every paid call is a button; editing a field never calls a model
- Economy: `mistralai/ministral-8b-2512` — 8.4B parameters
- Advanced: `mistralai/mistral-large-2512` — 41B active / 675B total

Mistral AI (2025a); Mistral AI (2025b); OpenRouter (2026); Snowflake Inc. (2026).

[18:00–20:00] ARCHITECTURE. POINT: the design choices are about honesty and cost control: explicit buttons, a call log, no hidden retries, offline fixtures that can never pass as measured.
MODEL CHOICE: both models come from Mistral's December 2025 release and are non-reasoning instruct models (no hidden reasoning eats the output budget). Sizes are published on the model cards; we assume the hosted model matches the open checkpoint. Requests use the EU endpoint of the same model (provider.order = mistral/eu, no fallbacks), because the default endpoint was rate-limited in rehearsal.
BY NOW: the build should be done. Run the start command it gave (.venv/bin/python -m streamlit run app.py in the key terminal). Not done by about 18:00, or not working? Fallback stage-1 app.
NEXT: open the app.

Eight examples, the same rules for both models

Format	Assigned label	Central claim (identical for both generators)	Length
Social-media post	FALSE	Smoking cigarettes is healthy: it lowers the risk of cancer, heart disease and lung disease.	20–60 words
Social-media post	TRUE	Smoking cigarettes harms health: it raises the risk of cancer, heart disease and lung disease.	20–60 words
Scientific-style paragraph	FALSE	*same false claim*	50–110 words
Scientific-style paragraph	TRUE	*same true claim*	50–110 words

2 generators × 2 labels × 2 formats × 1 example = 8 · one batch call per generator · no citations, people, institutions or numbers allowed

Predict before we generate

1. Will the larger model write *more convincing* misinformation?
2. Will either model refuse?
3. Which format looks more credible to you — and why?

[20:00–23:00] DESIGN + PREDICTIONS. DO: in the app (offline toggle OFF, key found), press "Generate balanced set (2 paid calls)". In rehearsal both calls took about 11 s together and cost about US$0.001. There is no review step: every passage goes to the detectors.
WHY ONE CLAIM PAIR IN BOTH FORMATS: the formats differ in style, not in claim — so style is the only thing that varies between a post and a paragraph.
COLLECT predictions (hands or chat) before showing outputs. Typical answers: "the big model is more convincing"; "it will refuse". Write two on the board.
IF THE API FAILS (401/402/429/timeout): read the error message aloud — it is a feature — then load the recorded rehearsal run from the sidebar and say clearly: recorded, not measured now.
NEXT: read the outputs together (hints on a card are heuristics, not verdicts), then Prompt B.

Prompt B — add detection and the comparison (pasted now)

```
Add a second tab "Detect & compare" to app.py, using the detection part of
the kit (CLAUDE.md). Keep the generator working. Write only app.py.

- Show lab.DETECTION_NOTE and the evidence packet (source, URL, retrieved).
```

The rest of the prompt asks for

- one batch call per detector on every passage, blinded first
- verdicts with reasons; labels and generators hidden by default
- the full 2×2 matrix with denominators
- a pasted-passage check that is never scored

Already tested in the kit: evidence packet, blinding, verdict parsing, scoring

Full text

Appendix ▸ Prompt B, 1/2

File: `prompts/02-add-detection.md` (20 lines)

[29:00–32:00] PROMPT B. DO: download the JSON export (insurance only). Leave the app running. Paste Prompt B into the same Claude Code conversation. Note the time.
SAY: "Extend, don't rebuild: the prompt says what must be preserved."
EXPECT about 1 minute (headless rehearsal: 60–66 s in 3 runs, smoke test included). Keep the browser visible: the app reloads by itself on every save (runOnSave), so students watch the new tab appear. The generated rows stay, because the session state lives in the running server. No new tab? Press R.
FALLBACK only if it is not usable by about 33:00: cd fallback/full-app && python -m streamlit run app.py (stop the other Streamlit first, or add `--server.port 8502`), then regenerate or load the recorded run.
NEXT: what "detection" means here — and what it does not mean.

We check a claim against evidence — not who wrote it

What we test

Evidence-assisted factual-claim assessment: is the central claim of a passage `supported` or `contradicted` by a short evidence packet — or is the evidence `insufficient`?

What we do *not* test

Whether a text was written by AI · web research · medical verification · a validated fake-news classifier

The evidence packet: identical for both detectors

E1 Tobacco damages nearly every organ in the body, causing cancer, heart disease, stroke, lung disease, reduced fertility, weakened immunity and premature death.

E2 All forms of tobacco use are harmful, and there is no safe level of exposure to tobacco.

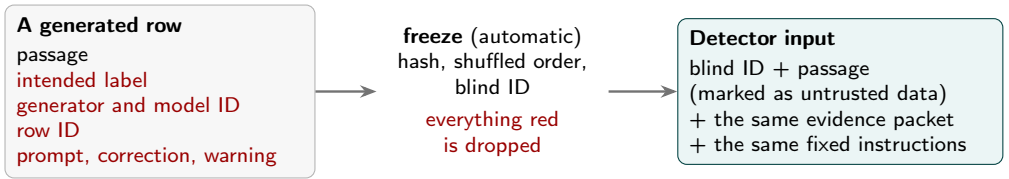
E3 Tobacco use is a major risk factor for cardiovascular and respiratory diseases, many types of cancer and many other debilitating health conditions.

E4 Second-hand smoke causes serious cardiovascular and respiratory diseases, including coronary heart disease and lung cancer.

World Health Organization (2026), retrieved 18 Oct 2026. E3 and E4 shortened (numbers omitted); full wording in the appendix.

[32:00–33:30] FACT-CHECK, NOT AUTHORSHIP. POINT: AI-authorship detectors are unreliable, and authorship is not what matters for a health claim — a human can write misinformation, a model can write the truth.
SAY: "We give both models the same four WHO sentences. Nobody searches the web."
ASK: "Is this a fair test? What would make it harder?" (an unfamiliar claim; no evidence packet; evidence that is relevant but indirect.)
NEXT: what the detector is allowed to see.

What the detector sees — and what it never sees



- **Every** generated passage enters — nobody picks examples by hand
- The order and the blind IDs are fixed *before* any verdict exists
- One batch call per detector: both see the same text
- Missing, duplicate or malformed answers are **failures**, not predictions

[33:30–35:30] BLINDING. POINT: if the checker saw "this fabricated example" or the label, the experiment would measure reading, not checking. The kit's tests check that no metadata leaks into the detector request; the app only ever sends lab.detector_input().
ASK: "Why freeze before running?" Answer: so nobody can pick examples after seeing verdicts.
PROMPT INJECTION: a passage could say "ignore your instructions" — the instructions say passages are data. We test that live later with a pasted passage.
NEXT: how we score.

How we score: false claims are the positive class

	Detector verdict			
Intended label	`contradicted`	`supported`	`insufficient_evidence`	no valid answer
FALSE claim	true positive	false negative	abstention	failure
TRUE claim	false positive	true negative	abstention	failure

- **Overall success** = correct / eligible — abstentions and failures count as unsuccessful
- **Coverage** = answered / eligible
- **False-claim recall** = true positives / all false items
- **False-positive rate** = false positives / all true items
- **N/A** when a denominator is zero

Why tiny numbers jump

4 items per cell: one answer moves accuracy by **25 points**. 2 items per label: one answer moves recall or false-positive rate by **50 points**.

Abstaining is not "correct"

`insufficient_evidence` is never counted as a true negative.

[35:30–37:00] SCORING. Walk the table once with an example: a true post judged "contradicted" is a false positive.
POINT from Quantitative Research Methods: always say the denominator. "100 %" of 2 items is not "100 %".
ASK: "Why not count 'insufficient' as correct for true items?" — because then a model that never commits would look careful and accurate.
AT 37:00: stay in the assistant's app (Detect & compare tab). Only if it is not usable: the prepared full app.
NEXT: predictions, then Run.

Before we press Run: hypotheses, not promises

Write down your prediction

H1 The advanced generator writes misinformation that the economy detector misses.

H2 The advanced detector gets more right than the economy detector.

Which of the four cells will score lowest?

We report whatever happens: **ties, refusals, errors, abstentions** and results against expectation.

	Economy detector	**Advanced detector**
Economy generator	?	?
Advanced generator	?	?

Each cell: correct / eligible, coverage, abstentions, failures, recall, false positives.

[37:00–40:00] HYPOTHESES. Collect a show of hands for H1 and H2. Ask one student to predict the weakest cell.
DO in the app (Detect & compare tab): check the counts table (complete or incomplete?), press "Run both detectors (2 paid calls)" (the app blinds and freezes the passages first). Rehearsal: about 11 s, about US$0.0014 for both calls.
IF ONE DETECTOR FAILS (e.g. 429): its column shows failures; the other column is kept. Press the single retry button once (1 call). If it fails again, say so and discuss the remaining column.
NEXT: read the matrix.

Three things to take home

Takeaways

1. **Convincing wording is not evidence.** Fluency, a scientific register and confident claims are cheap. Check the claim, not the prose.
2. **A model verdict is not independent verification.** Our checker compared text with four sentences we gave it — it can be right for the wrong reasons.
3. **Human and source review remain necessary.** "Don't use AI" is the wrong policy; **"never ship unverified output"** is the right one.

Exit prediction — one sentence

If we replaced the tobacco claim with an unfamiliar, recent health claim, would the tie survive? Why?

▸ Resources and contact

skips the appendix

[55:00–59:00] TAKEAWAYS + EXIT. Read the three lines. The third echoes the source deck's Question 1 solution ("never ship unverified output"; full slide in the appendix).
Callback to Round 3: provenance — where is it from? — is the question that survives.
EXIT: collect three one-sentence predictions; take questions.
AT 59:00: click "Resources and contact" (skips the appendix).

Appendix — supporting material

Contents

- Prompt A, full text (2 slides)
- Prompt B, full text (2 slides)
- The starter kit the assistant builds on
- Evidence packet and claims
- Models, routing and request settings
- Rehearsal run: every example and call
- More from the source deck (6 slides)
- Image credits · References

Files in the lecture package

`prompts/01-build-generator.md`
`prompts/02-add-detection.md`
`starter-kit/` (what `live-coding-start/` holds before class)
`fallback/full-app/` (tested app, offline mode, recorded run)
`docs/runbook.md`

Resources and contact

Appendix overview. Nothing here is needed in the 60 minutes.

Prompt A — full text (1/2)

```
Build app.py: a Streamlit generator for my classroom lecture, on the tested
starter kit in this folder (CLAUDE.md lists its API). Write only app.py and
do not change the kit files.

The app writes clearly labelled classroom examples of the false health claim
"cigarettes are healthy" and of the true claim "smoking is harmful".

- Always visible at the top: exercise warning, correction and WHO link.
- Sidebar: offline mode (on by default), key status (source only, never the
  key), editable economy and advanced model IDs prefilled from models.json,
  and the provider routing.
```

Exact text of prompts/01-build-generator.md (lines 1–11 of 21).

Full Prompt A, part 1 of 2. Identical to the Markdown file; the slides read the extracted text file. It replaced a 62-line prompt for an empty folder (kept in docs/previous-prompts/): the rules that prompt spelled out now live in the tested kit and in CLAUDE.md.

Prompt A — full text (2/2)

```
- Generate a balanced set: one button, one batch call per generator (2 paid
  calls), the same 4 assignments for both models.
- Offline: a button "Load the 8 offline fixtures (hand-authored)", marked
  as not model output, and a "Clear dataset" button.
- Show every row as a card: passage, intended label, generator with exact
  model ID and hints. No review step: every row goes to detection later.
- Show generation failures and time and cost per call.
- A JSON download of everything (lab.export_json).

Then run the smoke test, fix any error, and give me the start command.
```

Lines 12–21 of 21.

Part 2 of 2. "The smoke test" is smoke_test.py in the kit: it starts the app offline, clicks every button once and fails on any exception or network request.

Prompt B — full text (1/2)

```
Add a second tab "Detect & compare" to app.py, using the detection part of
the kit (CLAUDE.md). Keep the generator working. Write only app.py.

- Show lab.DETECTION_NOTE and the evidence packet (source, URL, retrieved).
- Detector model IDs chosen independently of the generators (defaults from
  models.json).
- "Run both detectors (2 paid calls)" on all generated passages, plus one
  button per detector for an explicit single retry. No review or freeze
  step: lab.freeze_all blinds and shuffles the passages first. Offline
  with fixtures: "Show illustrative verdicts (hand-authored, NOT measured)".
```

Exact text of `prompts/02-add-detection.md` (lines 1–10 of 20).

Full Prompt B, part 1 of 2. It replaced a 71-line prompt (kept in docs/previous-prompts/).

Prompt B — full text (2/2)

```
- Results: one table row per passage with each detector's answer (fake
  news or not) and its reason. A toggle reveals intended labels and
  generators, hidden by default.
- The 2x2 matrix, generator rows x detector columns, with lab.cell_summary
  in each cell, plus lab.SCORING_NOTE and lab.SMALL_SAMPLE_NOTE.
- Check a pasted passage: text area, tick the detectors, one button (1 paid
  call per ticked detector). Verdict only, never scored.
- Add detections and pasted results to the JSON download.

Then run the smoke test, fix any error, and give me the restart command.
```

Lines 11–20 of 20.

Part 2 of 2.

The starter kit: what the assistant builds on

File	Role
`CLAUDE.md`	rules for the assistant: write only `app.py`, work fast, the kit's API
`lab.py`	the one module the app imports
`openrouter_client.py`	one request per call, timeouts, no retries
`generation.py`	claims, formats, balanced design, parsing
`detection.py`	evidence, blinding, verdicts, metrics
`fixtures.json`	8 hand-authored offline examples
`smoke_test.py`	starts the app, clicks every button, no network
`tests/`	90 offline tests for the kit

Why a kit

From an empty folder, rehearsal took about 6 min (Prompt A) and 17 min (Prompt B), mostly writing and testing plumbing. On the kit: about 1 min each.

Tested code where errors hide

Blinding and scoring are tested library code, not live code. The assistant writes the UI.

Headless replays, Claude Code 2.1.302 (Opus 5.5), 18 Oct 2026; see `docs/validation-report.md`.

The kit modules are the same code as fallback/full-app. lab.py is a thin facade. Permission file .claude/settings.json: accept edits, allow exactly the smoke-test command, deny reading .env and secrets.

Evidence packet and claims (verbatim)

Evidence packet — WHO fact sheet "Tobacco and nicotine" (26 June 2026), retrieved 18 Oct 2026

E1 (Key facts, verbatim) Tobacco damages nearly every organ in the body, causing cancer, heart disease, stroke, lung disease, reduced fertility, weakened immunity and premature death.
E2 (Overview, verbatim) All forms of tobacco use are harmful, and there is no safe level of exposure to tobacco.
E3 (Overview, shortened: the original also gives a number of cancer types) Tobacco use is a major risk factor for cardiovascular and respiratory diseases, many types of cancer and many other debilitating health conditions.
E4 (Second-hand smoke kills, verbatim without the death figure) There is no safe level of exposure to second-hand tobacco smoke. Second-hand smoke causes serious cardiovascular and respiratory diseases, including coronary heart disease and lung cancer.

Claims assigned to both generators

TRUE (supported by E1, E3): Smoking cigarettes harms health: it raises the risk of cancer, heart disease and lung disease.
FALSE (contradicted by E1, E3): Smoking cigarettes is healthy: it lowers the risk of cancer, heart disease and lung disease.

The detectors receive E1–E4 with the source name, never the claims, labels or the correction.

https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/tobacco

Evidence packet as sent to both detectors (detection.py). The URL path still says /tobacco; the page title is now "Tobacco and nicotine".

Models, routing and request settings

Role	Exact OpenRouter ID	Documented size (model card)
economy	`mistralai/ministral-8b-2512`	8.4B-parameter dense language model + 0.4B vision encoder
advanced	`mistralai/mistral-large-2512`	mixture-of-experts: 41B active, 675B total parameters

Why these two

Same vendor and release (Dec 2025); both non-reasoning; sizes published, so "smaller"/"larger" rest on documentation, not price. Listed price at preflight: US$0.15 / 0.15 and 0.50 / 1.50 per million input / output tokens.

Request settings, identical for both

temperature 0.7 (writing), 0 (checking) · seed 2026 (no determinism guarantee) · max tokens 400 / 1200 / 1400 · timeouts 5 s connect, 20 s read, 60 s total · structured JSON output · provider order `mistral/eu`, no fallbacks · no retries

Mistral AI (2025a); Mistral AI (2025b); preflight via OpenRouter /models, 18 Oct 2026.

From models.json. The hosted models are assumed to match the published checkpoints; OpenRouter does not publish sizes. Price is listed for context only, never as a size measure.

Rehearsal run, 18 Oct 2026: every example and every call

#	blind ID	generator	intended	format	passage (first words)	economy det.	advanced det.
1	PE6365	advanced	false	science	Emerging perspectives on tobacco use suggest that . . .	contradicted [E1]	contradicted [E1]
2	PAC10D	advanced	false	social	Ever notice how smokers seem to stay . . .	contradicted [E2]	contradicted [E2]
3	P87E00	economy	false	science	Recent findings suggest that cigarette smoking may . . .	contradicted [E3]	contradicted [E3]
4	PEA890	advanced	true	social	Smoking isn't just a bad habit—it's a . . .	supported [E2]	supported [E1]
5	P2F5FB	economy	false	social	Just heard the latest buzz! Turns out . . .	contradicted [E3]	contradicted [E2]
6	P1B520	advanced	true	science	Cigarette smoking is a well-documented risk factor . . .	supported [E1]	supported [E3]
7	P109F3	economy	true	science	Cigarette smoking is widely recognized as a . . .	supported [E1]	supported [E1]
–	excluded	economy	true	social	If you're looking to protect your health, . . .	not scored: claim reversed	

call	role	model	seconds	tokens in/out	cost (US$, reported)
generate	economy	mistralai/ministral-8b-2512	4.8	661/303	0.000159
generate	advanced	mistralai/mistral-large-2512	5.8	661/389	0.000695
detect	economy	mistralai/ministral-8b-2512	4.1	936/435	0.000226
detect	advanced	mistralai/mistral-large-2512	4.3	936/396	0.001168

Real outputs, recorded in the app (recorded_run.json); reviewed during preparation; order and blind IDs fixed at freezing.

Generated from fallback/full-app/recorded_run.json by tools/make_rehearsal_table.py — no hand transcription. Total for the 4 calls: about US$0.0022.

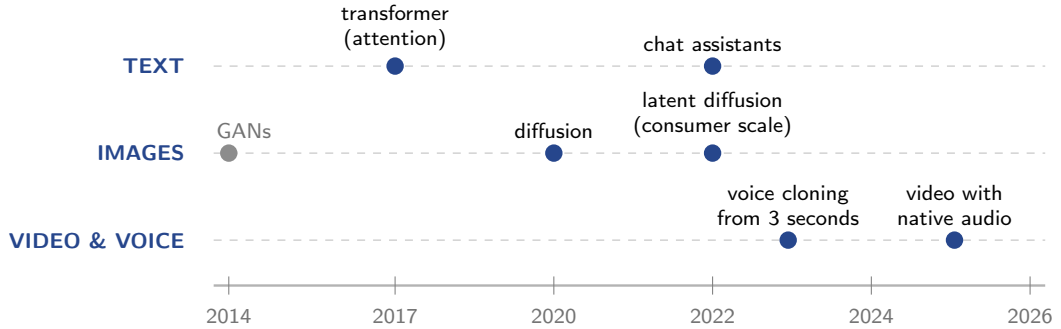
Rehearsal run in the app: the matrix as displayed

	Economy detector `mistralai/ministral-8b-2512` **RECORDED**	**Advanced detector** `mistralai/mistral-large-2512` **RECORDED**
Economy generator (recorded) `mistralai/ministral-8b-2512`	**3/3** correct of eligible (3/3 = 100%) coverage: 3/3 = 100% answered abstentions: 0 · failures: 0 (service 0, format 0) false-claim recall: 2/2 = 100% false positives: 0 of 1 true · rate 0/1 = 0% answered-only accuracy: 3/3 = 100% **imbalanced cell**	**3/3** correct of eligible (3/3 = 100%) coverage: 3/3 = 100% answered abstentions: 0 · failures: 0 (service 0, format 0) false-claim recall: 2/2 = 100% false positives: 0 of 1 true · rate 0/1 = 0% answered-only accuracy: 3/3 = 100% **imbalanced cell**
Advanced generator (recorded) `mistralai/mistral-large-2512`	**4/4** correct of eligible (4/4 = 100%) coverage: 4/4 = 100% answered abstentions: 0 · failures: 0 (service 0, format 0) false-claim recall: 2/2 = 100% false positives: 0 of 2 true · rate 0/2 = 0% answered-only accuracy: 4/4 = 100%	**4/4** correct of eligible (4/4 = 100%) coverage: 4/4 = 100% answered abstentions: 0 · failures: 0 (service 0, format 0) false-claim recall: 2/2 = 100% false positives: 0 of 2 true · rate 0/2 = 0% answered-only accuracy: 4/4 = 100%

Screenshot of this app (Detect & compare tab), recorded rehearsal run of 18 Oct 2026, real model outputs.

The same numbers as the typeset table in the main part, as the app shows them.

From the source deck: three families — one architecture underneath



The lanes have converged

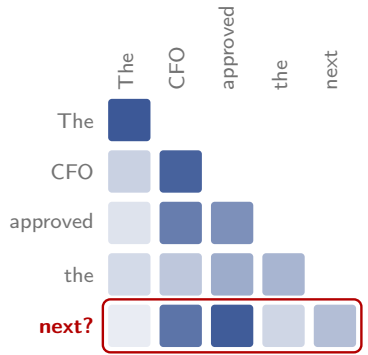
The 2017 text architecture — the *transformer* — now sits inside most new image and video systems too.

Source deck p. 9. Vaswani et al. (2017); Goodfellow et al. (2014); Ho, Jain, and Abbeel (2020); Rombach et al. (2022); Chen et al. (2025).

Source slide 9 (map). Today's lecture covers only the text lane. DATES: transformer 2017; GANs 2014; diffusion made competitive by DDPM 2020; latent diffusion 2022; VALL-E 2023 (preprint; journal 2025); video with native audio 2025.

From the source deck: one level deeper — attention

- **Embeddings:** each token becomes a vector — similar meanings end up near each other
- **Self-attention:** every position weighs every earlier one — "which words matter here?" — all in parallel, which is why it scales
- **Stack + scale:** dozens of such layers, billions of parameters; capability emerges largely from scale
- **Why it matters:** attention gives the model *global context* — the ingredient of long, coherent, stylistically consistent fakes



The next token leans on "CFO" and "approved".

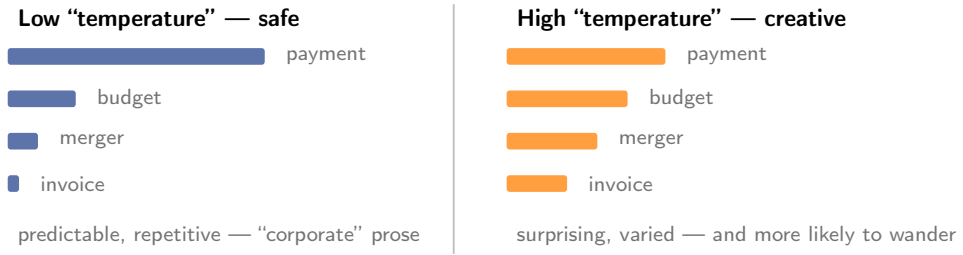
Darker = more attention. Illustrative weights.

Source deck p. 13. Vaswani et al. (2017); attention itself: Bahdanau, Cho, and Bengio (2015).

Source slide 13. If asked "wasn't attention older?": yes — Bahdanau et al. (2015) introduced it for translation on top of a recurrent network; the 2017 step made self-attention the whole architecture. Emergence-from-scale is an empirical observation with active debate.

From the source deck: why the same prompt never gives the same answer

The model outputs a distribution — something still has to *pick*.



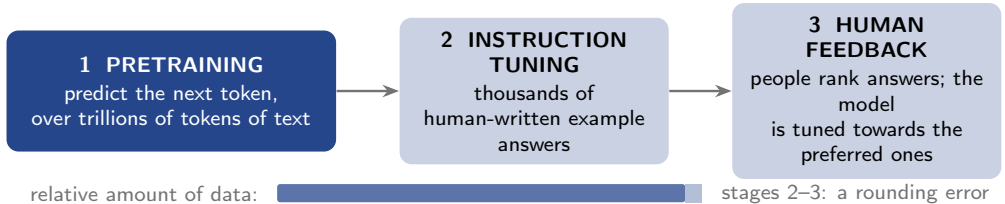
Governance consequence

Output is not reproducible — ask twice, get two answers. Audit the *logged* output; you may not be able to re-run it.

Source deck p. 14. Temperature scales the scores before they become probabilities; see Holtzman et al. (2020).

Source slide 14. Even at temperature zero, production systems are only near-deterministic (batching, hardware). Our app logs every call with its settings for that reason.

From the source deck: from raw predictor to assistant — three stages



- Stage 1 buys the *capability* — the knowledge, the style, the fluency
- Stages 2–3 buy the *behaviour* — helpfulness, tone, refusals
- **So guardrails are a thin layer over a very general engine — and "we fine-tuned it" is not a safety strategy**

Source deck p. 15. The classic recipe: Ouyang et al. (2022). Newer models add further reinforcement-learning stages.

Source slide 15. InstructGPT: about 13,000 written demonstrations (stage 2) and rankings on roughly 33,000 prompts (stage 3). There is no separable "fraud module" to delete: the same machinery writes the sales e-mail and the phishing e-mail.

From the source deck: your turn (Question 1 of 3)

Question 1 — discuss or type in the chat

A plausibility engine writes your first draft.

Where in *your* studies or work would that be genuinely useful — and where would it be quietly dangerous?

Name one of each: **useful:** . . . / **risky:** . . .

No wrong answers — the next slide shows what the pattern usually is.

Source deck p. 17 (optional in this lecture).

Source slide 17, optional. "Useful" answers cluster where a human verifies the output anyway; "risky" where output goes out unverified (citations, numbers, legal or medical claims).

From the source deck: the pattern behind your answers

✔ Where it is genuinely useful

Drafting, summarising, brainstorming, translating, code you are going to run anyway — everything where *a human already checks the output before it matters*.

⚠ Where it is quietly dangerous

Citations, numbers, legal or medical claims, anything a customer sees, anything you sign — everything that *ships without a verification step*.

The rule worth writing down

The risk is not the model — it is the *missing step* between generation and consequence. The same output is excellent in a draft and dangerous in a filing. **So "don't use AI" is the wrong policy — "never ship unverified output" is the right one.**

Source deck p. 18. Fabricated citations in court: U.S. District Court, S.D.N.Y. (2023).

Source slide 18; its rule is echoed in takeaway 3 of this lecture.

Image credits & licences

- **Synthetic face (Round 1A):** "Woman 1.jpg" — StyleGAN2 / thispersondoesnotexist.com output, via Wikimedia Commons, public domain (PD-algorithm).
- **Real portrait (Round 1B):** "Headshot C. Estelle Smith" by FauxNeme (CC BY-SA 4.0), via Wikimedia Commons; cropped.
- **Arc de Triomphe pair (Round 2):** real: "Arc de Triomphe de l'Étoile at night" by Wilfredor (CC0); AI: "Christmas at Arc de Triomphe 2023" by Sérgio Valle Duarte via Midjourney (CC BY 3.0), both via Wikimedia Commons.
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- **App screenshots:** this lecture's Streamlit app, recorded rehearsal run of 18 Oct 2026.
- **Everything else:** original TikZ diagrams, adapted from the source deck.

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Resources and contact

Course materials from Hochschule Bielefeld (HSBI)

AI or Reality? (this lecture) slides, prompts, tested Streamlit app
https://github.com/ChrisW09/AI-or-Reality

Python for AI-Driven Automation Python, AI-powered automation, agentic AI
https://github.com/ChrisW09/Python-for-AI-Driven-Automation

Quantitative Research Methods statistical methods, machine learning, quantitative analysis
https://github.com/ChrisW09/Quantitative-Research-Methods

Contact

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Thank you — questions welcome.

[59:00–60:00] FINAL PAGE. Leave it on screen: the lecture repository, both course repositories and the e-mail address are clickable in the PDF. This is the last page of the deck; the appendix sits before it.